

Monitorix: The Lightweight System Monitoring Tool

This article introduces readers to Monitorix, which can be a boon to systems administrators as well as those who like to keep tabs on their systems.

Administrators and, for that matter, typical users, often need to monitor servers for system resources like disk or CPU utilisation and other parameters to know how well the system is performing. There are many sophisticated system monitoring software such as Cacti, Munin and Nagios. Monitorix is a free, open source, lightweight system monitoring tool, designed to monitor many services and system resources.

Written in Perl, Monitorix has an inbuilt HTTP server. It consists of two programs—a collector called *monitorix*, which is a Perl daemon that is started automatically like any other system service, and a CGI script called *monitorix.cgi*.

Features

Here is a list of Monitorix's main features. For a more complete list, refer to the official site.

- System load and system service demand
- CPU/GPU temperature sensors
- Disk temperature and health

- Network/port traffic and netstat statistics
- Mail statistics
- Web server statistics (Apache, Nginx, Lighttpd)
- MySQL load and statistics
- Squid proxy statistics
- NFS server/client statistics
- Raspberry Pi sensor statistics
- Memcached statistics
- Fail2ban statistics
- Monitors remote servers (Multihost)
- Enables users to view statistics in graphs or in plain text tables on a daily, weekly, monthly or yearly basis
- Offers the capability to zoom graphs for a better view
- Has the capability to define the number of graphs per row

Prerequisites

For this article, I have chosen CentOS 6.6, 64-bit version, with minimal installation, which is equivalent to Red Hat 6.6. The steps are the same on CentOS 7 with just a few modifications in the commands.

1. Check the status of SELinux by using the command `sestatus`. If it is not disabled, then turn off SELinux, simply by changing `Enforcing to Disabled` in the `/etc/selinux/config` file.

